



Avery Lark

NEWSPAPER REPORTER

“Always one question away from the story of the year.”



◆ FOR YOUR EYES ONLY ◆

OPTIONAL · JOINS AT 7+

WHAT TO WEAR

A trench coat or a belted cardigan, a hat with a card tucked in the band reading “PRESS,” and a pencil behind one ear.

At the table you are: curious, quick and forever scribbling.

How this booklet works



Before the party: read page 2 alone. It holds your story and your secret.



Starter served: open Round 1 on page 3 when the host calls it.



Main course served: unfold page 3 and open Round 2.



Dessert served: open Round 3 on page 4, then vote.

Printed single-sided, so later rounds can't show through.



THE EVENING

Autumn, the 1930s. Bartholomew “Barty” Thistle, retired jam magnate, has invited a few old friends to the Harvest Supper at Thistledown House. Before the soup was served, Barty took a glass of elderflower cordial in the study, sat down for a rest, and never woke up. Someone at this table knows why.

Never show this booklet to anyone. You may bend the truth about your secret, but never about the evidence.



You are innocent.

You did not harm Barty, and you want the truth to come out.

You are an optional character. If you are not in the game, nothing breaks.

Your story

You report for the Fernley Gazette and were invited to cover the Harvest Supper for the society page. That is what you told everyone, anyway.

YOUR SECRET

Last week an unsigned letter came to the Gazette: “Ask who signs the Thistle Trust’s checks. £4,000 says it’s worth a story.” At 6:40 you slipped into the study hoping to see the Trust papers. Barty was in the armchair with eyes closed. You thought Barty was dozing and tiptoed out, leaving your pencil behind.

Where you were

6:30	Arrived by the station taxi (the late train was delayed).
6:30 - 6:40	Sherry in the drawing room.
6:40 - 6:43	In the study (your secret).
6:45	Back in the drawing room when Morgan raised the alarm.

Your goal tonight

Get the real story, and find the truth before morning. Keep the study visit quiet until Round 2 and the letter quiet until Round 3.

If someone asks you...

“When did you arrive?” “Half past six, on the station taxi. The driver will swear to it.”

“Why are you here?” “The society page. Hats, menus, who sat next to whom.”

“Is that your pencil in the study?” From Round 2: admit it.

YOUR NOTES BEFORE THE PARTY

[illegible]

Avery Lark • Rounds 1 & 2

ONE ROUND AT A TIME



Round 1 • Starter

OPEN ONLY WHEN THE HOST CALLS IT

Read only when the Starter is served.

SHARE THIS • My train was late. The station taxi set me down at the door at half past six, and the driver will swear to it.

- I am here for the society page. Hats, menus, who sat next to whom.

ASK

- **Rowan:** “How does it feel to be the heir of Thistledown?”

- **Harper:** “Have you ever written a kind word about anyone?”

YOUR TASK Take a pretend photograph of the three best-dressed suspects for the Gazette.



 FOLD OR CUT HERE · KEEP ROUND 2 HIDDEN UNTIL THE MAIN COURSE IS SERVED



Round 2 • Main Course

OPEN ONLY WHEN THE HOST CALLS IT

Read only when the Main Course is served.

SHARE THIS • I peeked into the study at 6:40. Barty was in the armchair with eyes closed. I thought Barty was napping and tiptoed out. I am so sorry.

- The glass on the desk was already empty, with the saucer beside it.

ASK

- **Morgan:** “When did you last see Barty awake?”

- **Quinn:** “What was Barty like out in the garden?”

YOUR TASK Interview one suspect for exactly one minute while the others time you.

NOTES · ROUNDS 1 AND 2

“MUST SHARE” lines are true and important. Say them during the round, in your own words.

Avery Lark • Round 3

THEN VOTE

OPEN ONLY WHEN THE HOST CALLS IT

Read only when the Dessert is served.

SHARE THIS

- Last week an unsigned letter came to the Gazette: “Ask who signs the Thistle Trust’s checks. £4,000 says it’s worth a story.”
- That is the real reason I came tonight.

ASK

- **Sage:** “Who signs the Thistle Trust’s checks?”
- **Ellis:** “Was the hospital wing ever going to be paid for by the Trust?”

YOUR TASK Read out tomorrow's Gazette headline as you imagine it.

NOTES

SUSPECTS AT A GLANCE (PUBLIC INFORMATION)

#	NAME	ROLE	#	NAME	ROLE
10	Rowan Thistle	Heir to Thistledown House	14	Harper Vale	Food Critic
11	Ellis Fairweather	Family Doctor	15	Quinn Ashby	Head Gardener
12	Morgan Pike	Steward of Thistledown House	16	Avery Lark	Newspaper Reporter
13	Sage Whitlock	Family Solicitor	17	Jules Marchetti	Visiting Chef